

Pildoo Sung

Assistant Professor of Sociology

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Academic Position

Hanyang University , Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology	Seoul, South Korea 2024 – present
Hong Kong Baptist University , Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology	Hong Kong 2023 – 2024
Duke-NUS Medical School , Research Fellow, Centre for Ageing Research and Education (CARE)	Singapore 2020 – 2023

Education

PhD National University of Singapore , Sociology	Singapore 2020
MA Korea University , Sociology	Seoul, South Korea 2014
BA Korea University , Sociology	Seoul, South Korea 2009

Research Interests

Research: Social Capital, Social Participation, Social Isolation, Loneliness, Social Gerontology, Caregiving, Longitudinal Analysis

Work in Progress

Associating Multimorbidity Patterns with Healthcare Utilization and Unmet Healthcare Needs among Older Koreans Living Alone

Yun, H., Son, B., & Sung, P. — Status: Under review.

Lonely by Comparison: Understanding Loneliness Through Network Alter Status, Ego Status, and Regional Status

Sung, P., Sung, W., & Kim, H. — Status: Under review.

Stability and Transitions in Social Network Types in the Pandemic Outbreak and Their Association with Mid-pandemic Depression among Older Koreans

Sung, P., & Son, J. — Status: Under review.

The Strength of Strong Ties: Resources in Close Relationships and Life Satisfaction Across 30 Countries

Sung, P., & Son, J. — Status: Draft available.

Drifting into Isolation or Growing into the Core? Joint Trajectories of In-Degree and Out-Degree Centrality and Later-Life Cognitive Function among Older Adults

Sung, P., & Youm, Y. — Status: Draft available.

Adherence Trajectories and Determinants of Adherence Transition Patterns from Active Intervention to Self-Maintenance Phases of an Exercise-based Falls Prevention Programme

Koh, V. J. W., Sung, P., Tan, K. Y., Lee, J. M.-L., & Chan, A. — Status: Draft available.

Post-retirement Trajectories of Depressive Symptoms in South Korea: The Positive Role of Returning to Work

Lim-Soh, J., Xiang, C. H., Ang, S., Sung, P., & Malhotra, R. — Status: Draft available.

Conference Presentations

Oral Health-Related Quality of Life and Formal Social Engagement Among Older Adults: How Does Gender Matter? 2025 – 2026

- 2026 — Singapore Conference on Ageing and Health 2026, Singapore
- 2025 — Hong Kong Sociological Association 26th Annual Conference, Hong Kong

Who Keeps on Learning? Understanding Heterogeneity in Resource Profiles of Older Learners to Promote Recurrent Engagement in Learning 2025

- Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea

Lonely by Comparison: Individual, Network, and Regional Occupational Status and Loneliness across 30 Countries 2025

- 5th ISA Forum of Sociology, Rabat, Morocco

Reciprocal Relationship Between Oral Health and Social Engagement Among Older Adults: A Gendered Story 2025

- 5th ISA Forum of Sociology, Rabat, Morocco

Exploring Loneliness in Family Caregiver-Care Recipient Dyads: Implications for Care-giver Burden 2024 – 2025

- 2025 — Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Singapore
- 2024 — Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea

Connected, yet Vulnerable: Stress, Social Isolation, and Mental Health among Older Adults 2024 – 2025

- 2025 — Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Singapore
- 2024 — Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea

Mechanisms Linking Oral Health and Mental Health in Later Life: The Mediating Role of Social Engagement and Life Satisfaction 2024

- International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference, Oxford, UK
- Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Singapore

Stability and Change in Social Network Profiles after Widowhood and Their Impact on Mental Health among Older Adults 2023

- Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea

Oral Health, Social Engagement, and Depressive Symptoms among Older Adults 2023

- Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea

Understanding Resource Profiles of Older Learners to Promote Recurring Engagement in Learning 2023

- Hong Kong Sociological Association 24th Annual Conference, Hong Kong
- Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Tampa, Florida

Feeling Alone Together: Loneliness among Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment and their Family Caregivers with Low Mastery • Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Tampa, Florida • Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Jeonju, Korea	2023
Profiles of Volunteer Motivations During the COVID-19 Pandemic and Their Implications for Volunteer Activities • XX ISA World Congress of Sociology, Melbourne, Australia	2023
Social Capital and Life Satisfaction: A Cross-national Comparison • Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Jeonju, Korea	2023
Stability and Change in Social Isolation Profiles over Time Among Older Adults • 2023 — Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Tampa, Florida • 2022 — International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference, Copenhagen, Denmark	2022 – 2023
Change in Social Network Types among Older Koreans before and during the COVID-19 Pandemic • 2023 — XX ISA World Congress of Sociology, Melbourne, Australia • 2023 — Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Singapore • 2022 — Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea • 2022 — Japan Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Osaka, Japan	2022 – 2023
Caregiver Social Network Types and Depressive Symptoms: The Mediating Role of Psychological Resilience • 2023 — Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Singapore • 2022 — Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea	2022 – 2023
Transitions in Social Network Types among Older Singaporeans • International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference, Copenhagen, Denmark	2022
Transitions in Social Support Exchange Profiles over Time among Older Adults • Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Indianapolis, Indiana	2022
Profiles of Met and Unmet Needs of Cognitively Impaired Older Singaporeans and Their Association with Caregiver Well-being • Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Virtual	2021
Met and Unmet Needs of Cognitively Impaired Older Adults and Burden and Benefits of Their Caregivers • Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Virtual	2021
Transitions in Adherence Trajectories from Intervention to Maintenance of a Falls Prevention Exercise Program • Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Virtual	2021
Caregiving Experience Types and Caregiver Quality of Life • Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Virtual	2020
Trust, Social Participation, and Depression among Older Adults in Low- and Middle-Income Countries • International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference, Singapore	2018

Trust and Well-being: A Multi-country Analysis	2018
• XIX International Sociological Association World Congress of Sociology, Toronto, Canada	
Trust and Self-rated Health in East Asia	2018
• International Sociological Association RC 28 Spring Meeting, Seoul, Korea	
Parental Volunteering, Church Attendance, and Young Adults' Volunteering	2018
• International Sociological Association joint conference for RC06 & RC41, Singapore	
Global Pioneer Seeks for Globality: Institutionalization, Crisis, and Restructuring of E-Sports in Korea	2015
• East Asian Conference for Young Sociologists, Seoul, Korea	
Structural Change in the Oil Industry in Korea	2014
• Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea	
Invited Talks	
Lonely by Comparison: Individual, Network, and Regional Occupational Status and Loneliness across 30 Countries	2025
• Medical sociology colloquium, Korea University	
Social Determinants of Mental Health Among Older Adults in Korea	2025
• Korea University Institute of Aging	
• Korea Inequality Research Network	
Trust and Social Capital	2024
• Global Multicultural Education Center, Sun Moon University	
Reciprocal Relationship Between Oral Health and Social Engagement among Older Adults: A Gendered Story	2024
• Medical sociology colloquium, Ewha Womans University	
Stability and Change in Social Network Profiles after Widowhood and Their Impact on Mental Health among Older Koreans	2024
• Department of Geography, National University of Singapore	
Multi-wave Panel Data Analysis	2023
• Department of Internal Medicine, The Catholic University of Korea	
Composition and Dynamics of Social Networks among Older Singaporeans	2023
• Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Duke-NUS Medical School	
Health Profiles among Community Dwelling Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment and Their Implications for Caregiving Experience	2022
• Singapore General Hospital 24th Annual Scientific Meeting	
Transition in Social Network Types among Older Singaporeans and Implications to Life-space Studies	2022
• Singapore Population Health Symposium	
The Reciprocal Relationship Between Volunteering and Lifelong Learning	2021
• Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Duke-NUS Medical School	

Profiles of Caregiving Experience Types Based on the Benefits and Burden of Caregiving, and Their Association with Caregiver Mental Health and Quality of Life • Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Duke-NUS Medical School	2021
Social Networks and Health among Older Adults • Department of Sociology, Korea University	2020
Social Capital and Life Satisfaction • Department of Sociology, National University of Singapore	2019
Online Interaction and Out-group Trust • Centre for Family and Population Research, National University of Singapore	2019
Trust and Happiness among Older Adults in Low- and Middle-income Countries • Faculty of Arts & Social Science Research Division Health Cluster, National University of Singapore	2019
Social Capital and Trust • Department of Sociology, National University of Singapore	2018

Honors, Grants & Awards

- HYU International Collaboration Grant (PI), Hanyang University (2025–2026)
- Start-up Grant, Hanyang University (2024)
- Travel Award, Department of Geography, National University of Singapore (2024)
- Start-up Grant, Hong Kong Baptist University (2023)
- Travel Award, Japanese Sociological Society (2022)
- Research Scholarship, Department of Sociology, National University of Singapore (2015–2019)
- The Best Article Award, Korea University Graduate Studies (2015)
- Research Scholarship, Korea University (2012–2014)

Teaching Experience

Hanyang University , Instructor • Health and Social Behavior [SOC4046] • Social Problems [SOC3032] • Medical Sociology Seminar, Graduate [SOC9116] • Social Networks and Social Capital, Graduate [SOC9115]	Seoul, South Korea 2025 – 2026
Hanyang University , Instructor • Sociology and the New Industrial Revolution [SOC1055] • Intermediate Social Statistics, Graduate [SOC9109]	Seoul, South Korea 2024 – 2024
Hong Kong Baptist University , Instructor • Careers and Life Courses [SOCI3027] • Globalization [SOCI4016]	Hong Kong 2023 – 2024
Duke-NUS Medical School , Instructor, Methods Workshop: Latent Class/Transition Analysis Delivered at the Centre for Ageing Research and Education (2021–2023); also invited to the Association of Pacific Rim Universities Population Aging Program and the Department of Sociology, Korea University (2022).	Singapore 2021 – 2023

National University of Singapore, Teaching Assistant

Singapore

2015 – 2018

- Data Analysis in Social Research [SC3209], 2018
- Sociology of Life Course and Ageing [SC3214], 2017
- Understanding Globalization [GEK1041], 2016
- Making Sense of Society [SC1101], 2015

Professional Service

BMC Geriatrics, Editorial Board Member

2024 – present

Korean Journal of Sociology, Editorial Board Member

2024 – present

Journal of the Korean Gerontological Society, Editorial Board Member

2023 – 2024

Health and Social Science, Editorial Board Member

2023 – 2024

Hong Kong Baptist University, Grant Reviewer, Seed Grant Funding Scheme

2023 – 2023

19th Seoul International Symposium on Gerontology, Organizing Committee Member

2025 – 2025

Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Organizing Committee Member

2023 – 2023

12th Association of Pacific Rim University Population Ageing Conference, Organizing Committee Member

2022 – 2022

Journal Reviewer

Reviewer for: Aging and Health Research, Australian & New Zealand Journal of Public Health, BMC Geriatrics, BMC Public Health, Dementia and Geriatric Cognitive Disorders, Health & Place, Health Psychology, Health and Social Science, International Journal of Comparative Sociology, Journal of Aging and Health, Journal of Applied Gerontology, Journal of the Korean Gerontological Society, Korea Journal of Population Studies, Korean Journal of Sociology, Scientific Reports, Social Science Research, Sociology of Health & Illness, The Gerontologist, The Journals of Gerontology Series B

Professional Organization Membership

Member of: Gerontological Society of America, Hong Kong Sociological Association, International Alliance of Research Universities Aging Longevity and Health Early Career Researcher Network, International Sociological Association (RC55 Social Indicators), Korean Gerontological Association, Korean Sociological Association, Population Association of Singapore